was arrived at. Chapman further claimed that the bankruptcy of the company was beyond doubt.

However, Wynch, considering the liquidation of the company inopportune—especially if it coincided with VOC's conviction—asked Chapman if BI could come to any arrangement with the Swadeshi company. Chapman's answer was an emphatic 'no', explained by nine points including the following: BI was bound by their earlier contracts with various agencies; not classed A1 by Lloyd's insurance, the Swadeshi steamers could not carry cotton, fibre, tea and some other articles; BI was also bound by brokering arrangements with other ocean-going lines; lending a helping hand to SSNCo would oblige BI to take over other tottering concerns running between Bombay, Madras, Calcutta and Rangoon; lastly, there was definitely no room for two liners on the Tuticorin–Colombo route. Another reason he adduced was that 'the B.I. steamers being more regular and finer vessels would get the traffic and the steamers would run empty unless they resorted to trickery of some sort'. Shipping, both coasting and ocean-going, was in a bad way, and BI had already laid up eighteen steamers in Calcutta for want of freight. Moreover, it was impossible to dispose of the *Gallia* without extensive alterations and repairs. This was quite a list, and to Wynch's mind, these were unassailable reasons, therefore he could see no way to help the SSNCo.[60]

Wynch claimed that both C. Vijayaraghavachari and A. Sundara Sastri had admitted that Chapman had dealt with them 'in the most sympathetic possible manner and had been perfectly frank and straightforward'. He also pointed out how, in the case against VOC, the defence did not press the allegation that Ashe had been instigated by Chapman to wreck the Swadeshi company. Wynch contended that the directors had 'no moral courage to wind up the company'. Weak and with little influence, they feared the press and the extremists. Consequently, he expected them to follow dilatory tactics and postpone the inevitable. 'They will go on till their steamers are arrested for coal-nil or for non-payment of the instalments still due, and then wind up and abuse Government and the unfair competition of the white man.' This was all of a piece with their lack of spine in standing up to